Daniela Banda-Hernandez

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EDUCATION

UNIVERSITY OF SOUTHERN CALIFORNIA – Los Angeles, CA — Expected May 2028

Bachelor of Science in *Computer Science Games*

AWARDS: HSF Scholar, HITEC Scholar, QuestBridge Scholar

RELEVANT COURSES: Video Game Programming, Mobile Game Development, Game Design Workshop, Data Structures

TECHNICAL SKILLS

PROGRAMMING LANGUAGES: C++, C#, Java, JavaScript, Python

TOOLS: Unity, Perforce, Git/GitHub, Ink, Cursor, LLM Tool Calling, Adobe Creative Suite, Figma

LANGUAGES (spoken): English, Spanish (bilingual)

GAME PROJECTS

Ur So Messy! - CTIN 489: Intermediate Game Design Workshop — Sep 2026 - Present

Co-Creator, Gameplay Programmer & Technical Designer

- Built the core loop on a 2-person team by programming the matching mini-game's cards, match checks, and timer.
- Made mini-game results shape each date by building a data-driven affection system with ScriptableObjects.
- Scaled difficulty by writing shaders that desaturate and hue-shift cards, migrating to URP for Shader Graph.
- Unlocked new suitors each day by implementing day progression and per-chat dialogue state in Ink.

Homesick - Solo Project — Sep 2026 - Oct 2026

Sole Developer

- Built a first-person narrative game in Unity where players relive family memories while packing up a childhood home.
- Paced the story by building fade-to-black memory sequences on unscaled time and a trigger-based ending.
- Let new memories ship as data, not code, by designing a ScriptableObject-based memory system.
- Made pickup feel smooth with sphere-cast grabs and kinematic holding, fixing jitter and collision bugs.

Open Your Browser (OYB) - Open Alpha — Jan 2025 - May 2025

Game Design Lead

- Shipped on itch.io by co-leading a 10-person design team and directing characters, dialogue, and world-building.
- Kept the game in scope by translating designs into clear specs for programmers and answering their questions.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Booz Allen Hamilton - El Segundo, CA — Jun 2026 - Aug 2026

Software Engineering Intern

- Took an AI satellite mission planner from idea to working product in 10 weeks by co-building it in Cursor.
- Let planners turn plain-English prompts into mission plans by connecting the UI to the AI agent's API layer.
- Helped keep AI-generated plans accurate by having the LLMs call deterministic tools instead of guessing.
- Shaped the planner's UX by leading its React frontend: 80+ components, landing page, and 3D intro.
- Let planners see orbits, ground assets, and coverage at a glance via a 3D globe built in React Three Fiber.
- Helped planners coordinate missions by building timeline playback, scheduling, and constellation controls.
- Kept app data current by integrating REST APIs for mission plans, locations, and live orbit (TLE) updates.

Lvl∞nity - Los Angeles, CA — Jan 2026 - Present

Co-Founder, *Backend & Full-stack Developer*

- Co-founded a game-inspired platform for collaborative project sharing, building it in React and Firebase.
- Laid the backend foundation for profiles and sharing by architecting the database schema and REST APIs.
- Secured user accounts by implementing authentication flows and core backend business logic.

USC Games Career Center - Los Angeles, CA — Sep 2026 - Present

Student Assistant

- Connect USC Games students with studios by coordinating career fairs, workshops, and recruiter events.

LEADERSHIP

Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers (SHPE) — Aug 2024 - Present

Co-Vice President of Marketing

- Helped double mentorship sign-ups year over year by co-leading chapter marketing and designing flyers.